

September

7



1695

Pirates ahoy!

Notorious English pirate Henry “Long Ben” Every raided the *Ganj-i-Sawai*, the Mughal flagship loaded with treasures on its way to Surat, India. Every and his crew looted items equivalent to millions of pounds in today’s currency, and were never heard from again.

Also on this day

1812 French emperor Napoleon Bonaparte’s army defeated Russian forces in the bloody Battle of Borodino in Russia.

1923 The International Criminal Police Organization, commonly known as INTERPOL, was founded in Vienna, Austria. It is the world’s largest police organization and serves as a link between police departments around the world.

1822

Emperor of Brazil

Defying the decision of Portugal’s parliament, Portuguese prince Dom Pedro supported Brazil’s desire for freedom and declared the country independent of Portugal. Pedro would become Brazil’s emperor. Brazilians celebrate this date as their independence day.



Born this day

1943 Gloria Gaynor, Black American singer. One of the most prominent singers of the disco era, she is known for many hits, including the classic *I Will Survive*.

The Blitz begins **1940**

During the early years of World War II, the Luftwaffe (German air force) began swift and targeted bombing of major cities in the UK, including London (below), Liverpool, and Portsmouth. The attack was called the Blitz, short for Blitzkrieg, the German word for “lightning war”.

